

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-05

Stakeholder Engagement Plan

The strategies and actions to move stakeholders to the engagement level the project needs

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Stakeholder Engagement Plan
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Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-04	Stakeholder Register	Source of the engagement gaps
PMB-20	Communications Management Plan	Delivers many of these actions
MSP-13	Stakeholder Engagement and Communications Plan	Programme equivalent

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Defines the approach for engaging each stakeholder or group — the strategy, the actions, the owner and the measures of effectiveness — in order to close the gap between current and desired engagement.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Stakeholder Management — Plan Stakeholder Engagement
Created when	During planning, after the stakeholder register
Reviewed / updated	At every phase boundary and when engagement is not working
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Focus effort on the gaps. Stakeholders already at the desired level need maintenance, not a campaign.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Strategies are tailored to the individual, not a single approach applied to everyone
- Actions have owners and dates
- Effectiveness is measured by observed behaviour, not by activity completed
- It addresses resistant stakeholders explicitly rather than avoiding them
- It is aligned to, not duplicated by, the communications management plan

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1. Engagement objectives

What the project needs from stakeholders overall — decisions, resources, adoption, advocacy.

Engagement is weighted toward the two groups whose behaviour determines whether the benefit lands: the business units being asked to decommission departmental clusters, and the researchers being asked to change how they work. Fraud Analytics is currently resistant and is engaged directly by the Business Change Lead with the sponsor available to arbitrate on scheduling policy.

2. Engagement strategies by stakeholder

Ref	Stakeholder	Current	Desired	Strategy	Key messages	Owner
ESB-01	M. Duarte, Head of Fraud Analytics	Verified at hall A acceptance on 26 Feb 2027	72% by Q4 2027	Monthly one-to-one between the SRO and the Head of Fraud Analytics on scheduling policy	Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO
ESB-02	All tenant representatives	Carried forward from the Tranche 1 lessons register	3 days median	Publish the fair-share quota model and priority queue design to all three tenants before build	Excluded from Tranche 2 and deferred to the AUH-2 second site	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead
ESB-03	Business unit finance partners	Applies only to workloads classified Restrictive or above	AED 5.1m per year	Rate card briefing for business unit finance partners a full budget cycle ahead of charging	Reviewed at each PI boundary by the Release Train Engineer	C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner
ESB-04	Researcher and data scientist community	Reported through the monthly benefit tracking report	Under 2 hours	Researcher onboarding cohorts with hands-on lab time	Reflected in the solution intent as a fixed constraint	F. Mansour, Business Change Lead
ESB-05	L. Haddad, CISO and Group Security	Aligned to the strategic theme of sovereign AI capability	Zero open critical findings	Joint design sessions with Group Security at each architecture option stage	Constrained by the 6.2 MVA site limit at DXB-1 until 2028	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect
ESB-06	Enterprise Identity	Reviewed	92% at 256-GPU	Escalation route to the Portfolio Board for the	Handled through the Agile Release Train	K. Adeyemi,

Ref	Stakeholder	Current	Desired	Strategy	Key messages	Owner
	Programme Manager	monthly at the Programme Board	job scale	identity federation dependency	rather than the predictive workstreams	Security Architect
ESB-07	Group Internal Audit	Covers the 2,048-GPU estate and the parallel filesystem tier	1.21 PUE	Quarterly walkthrough of the RAID log with Group Internal Audit	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)	M. Verity, Head of P3O
ESB-08	Head of Property and Facilities	Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build	72% by Q4 2027	Facilities load-change notification and PUE reporting to Group Property	Handled through the Agile Release Train rather than the predictive workstreams	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead

3. Engagement actions

Ref	Action	Stakeholder ref	Owner	Frequency / date	Status
EA-01	Monthly one-to-one between the SRO and the Head of Fraud Analytics on scheduling policy	M. Duarte, Head of Fraud Analytics	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Monthly from Sep 2026	Running
EA-02	Publish the fair-share quota model and priority queue design to all three tenants before build	All tenant representatives	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	One-off, 30 Sep 2026	Complete
EA-03	Rate card briefing for business unit finance partners a full budget cycle ahead of charging	Business unit finance partners	C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	One-off, 08 Oct 2026	Scheduled
EA-04	Researcher onboarding cohorts with hands-on lab time	Researcher and data scientist community	F. Mansour, Business Change Lead	Fortnightly cohorts from Oct 2026	Running
EA-05	Joint design sessions with Group Security at each architecture option stage	L. Haddad, CISO and Group Security	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect	At each design freeze	Running

Ref	Action	Stakeholder ref	Owner	Frequency / date	Status
EA-06	Escalation route to the Portfolio Board for the identity federation dependency	Enterprise Identity Programme Manager	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect	Until resolved	Escalated
EA-07	Quarterly walkthrough of the RAID log with Group Internal Audit	Group Internal Audit	M. Verity, Head of P3O	Quarterly	Running
EA-08	Facilities load-change notification and PUE reporting to Group Property	Head of Property and Facilities	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Monthly	Running

4. Resistant stakeholders

Name the objection and the response. Resistance ignored at planning becomes an issue at delivery.

Ref	Stakeholder	Nature of resistance	Underlying concern	Response	Owner
RS-01	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Verified at hall A acceptance on 26 Feb 2027	Scheduled fraud workloads could be pre-empted by research jobs	Broker all vendor access through the monitored in-country jump host	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
RS-02	L. Haddad, CISO	Constrained by the 6.2 MVA site limit at DXB-1 until 2028	Design change after the structural order would require rework	Confirm vendor allocation in writing before placing the structural order	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
RS-03	A. Rahimi, CFO	Aligned to the strategic theme of sovereign AI capability	Chargeback introduces cost where compute was previously free	Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner
RS-04	Dr S. Iyer, Head of AI Research	Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026	Departmental autonomy is removed with no compensating guarantee	Retune CDU set-points and model a secondary heat rejection loop	V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement
RS-05	M. Duarte, Head of Fraud Analytics	Owned within WS4 Platform and orchestration	Scheduled fraud workloads could be pre-empted by research jobs	Secure written migration commitments from three business units	F. Mansour, Business Change Lead

5. Measuring engagement effectiveness

Measure	How assessed	Frequency	Target
Attendance at governance meetings	<i>Live walkthrough with a recorded session</i>	<i>Each planning interval</i>	<i>72% by Q4 2027</i>
Decision turnaround time	<i>60 minutes</i>	<i>Each iteration</i>	<i>4 weeks</i>
Change requests originating from unengaged areas	<i>Written pack circulated 48 hours in advance</i>	<i>Each iteration</i>	<i>3 days median</i>
Adoption rate post-deployment	<i>AED 1,120,000</i>	<i>Each planning interval</i>	<i>AED 4,200,000</i>

6. Interrelationships between stakeholders

Who influences whom. Often the fastest route to a resistant stakeholder is through someone else.

Stakeholder	Influenced by	Nature of relationship	Implication
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	H	<i>Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance</i>	<i>Reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing</i>
L. Haddad, CISO	H	<i>Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026</i>	<i>On-call rota cannot be sustained beyond a 5x8 model at handover</i>
A. Rahimi, CFO	H	<i>Subject to closure of ISS-003 before multi-tenant go-live</i>	<i>Reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing</i>
Dr S. Iyer, Head of AI Research	M	<i>Confirmed with the FM provider under the existing facilities contract</i>	<i>On-call rota cannot be sustained beyond a 5x8 model at handover</i>
M. Duarte, Head of Fraud Analytics	M	<i>Assured independently by Cordant Assurance</i>	<i>Reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing</i>